must be developed in parallel. In Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb', the main thrust was on the security aspect, whereas the other two aspects were ignored. The pace to build the war-ravaged areas was too slow and Temporarily Displaced Persons (TDPs) were facing severe hardships in camps and temporary abodes. In the long-term, this gap might boomerang as the local population potentially get fed up and many might start siding with the insurgents.

There has been a large exodus of almost 1 million TDPs who are still languishing in camps or have taken shelter at different places. These TDPs were facing endless miseries and were at the mercy of vagaries of extreme weathers and inhospitable conditions. Social fabric of North Waziristan and FATA was severely shattered. How long would it take to bring it back to normalcy? Or will it ever?

Moreover, it was a point of concern that the information of successes, failures, deaths and arrests of the operation was only provided by the military source. There was no independent source to authenticate it. It also highlighted the absence of civil oversight over the military offensives in FATA. COIN is a complex and difficult campaign, which can become controversial politically. People of the area can stop distinguishing between the operational forces and the militants. Therefore, it required continuous monitoring, evaluation and assessment by the civil government.

Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb' did achieve successes by dismantling the command and control structures of the insurgents. There was a tangible reduction in terrorist attacks in urban areas. However, counter-insurgency campaigns took longer to achieve ultimate success. The insurgents dispersed, melted away and then reassembled to fight back. It was quite difficult to totally eliminate insurgent activity. So much more was required. It would have been considered a successful operation if TTP's leadership was neutralised, marginalised or separated from the population. Furthermore, its success would also be measured by TTP's demobilisation or reintegration into the political, economic and social structures of the country.

As suggested above, the economic and governance activity must start immediately without waiting for the end of the military operation stage. Everything, including the military operations, ought to be done under civil oversight. When most of the area of FATA had been reclaimed, there should have been strategic change in the operation and more